



PHP

Presented by
Nguyễn Đức Thái
Ho Chi Minh City University of Technology

Outline

- Introduction

Introduction

- PHP is an acronym for "PHP: Hypertext Preprocessor"
- PHP is a **widely-used, open source** scripting language
- PHP scripts are **executed *on the server***
- PHP is a powerful tool for making ***dynamic* and *interactive* Web pages**
- PHP is ***free* to download and use.**

PHP File

- PHP files can *contain* text, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and PHP code
- PHP code is executed *on the server*, and the **result** is returned to the browser *as plain HTML*
- PHP files have extension ".php"

What Can PHP Do?

- PHP can generate *dynamic* page content
- PHP can create, open, read, write, delete, and close files on the server
- PHP can collect *form data*
- PHP can send and receive cookies
- PHP can add, delete, modify data in your database
- PHP can be used to **control** *user-access*
- PHP can **encrypt** *data*
- With PHP you are not limited *to output* HTML.
- You can **output** images, PDF files, and even Flash movies.
- You can also **output** any text, such as XHTML and XML.

Why PHP?

- PHP runs on *various platforms* (Windows, Linux, Unix, Mac OS X, etc.)
- PHP is *compatible* with almost **all servers** used today (Apache, IIS, etc.)
- PHP supports a *wide range* of **databases**
- PHP is **free**. (www.php.net)
- PHP is *easy to learn* and *runs efficiently* on the server side

PHP Installation

- To start using PHP, you can:
 - *Find a web host* with **PHP** and **MySQL** support
 - *Install a web server* on your own PC, and then *install PHP and MySQL*
- Use a Web Host With PHP Support
 - If your server has activated support for PHP you do not need to do anything.
 - Just create some **.php files**, place them in your web directory, and the server will automatically parse them for you.
 - You *do not need* to **compile** anything or **install** any extra tools.
 - Because PHP is free, *most web hosts offer PHP support.*

PHP Syntax

- A PHP script is executed *on the server*, and the plain HTML result is sent back to the browser.
- A PHP script can be *placed anywhere* in the document.
- A PHP script starts with `<?php` and ends with `?>`

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h1>My first PHP page</h1>

<?php
echo "Hello World!";
?>

</body>
</html>
```


PHP Case Sensitive

- In PHP, **keywords** (e.g. **if**, **else**, **while**, **echo**, etc.), classes, functions, and user-defined functions **are not** case-sensitive.
- However, **all variable names** are **case-sensitive!**

PHP Comments

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<?php
// This is a single-line comment

# This is also a single-line comment|

/*
This is a multiple-lines comment block
that spans over multiple
lines
*/

?>

</body>
</html>
```

PHP Variables

- In PHP, a variable **starts** with the **\$** sign, followed by the **name** of the **variable**.
- Rules for PHP variables:
 - A variable name must *start with a letter* or the *underscore* character
 - A variable name *cannot start with a number*
 - A variable name **can only contain** *alpha-numeric characters* and *underscores* (A-z, 0-9, and _)
 - Variable names are *case-sensitive*
(\$age and \$AGE are two different variables)

Output Variables

- The PHP **echo** statement is often used to output data to the screen.

```
<?php
$txt = "W3Schools.com";
echo "I love $txt!";
?>
```

```
<?php
$txt = "W3Schools.com";
echo "I love " . $txt . "!";
?>
```

```
<?php
$x = 5;
$y = 4;
echo $x + $y;
?>
```

- PHP variables can be declared *anywhere* in the script.
- PHP has *three* different variable **scopes**:
 - local
 - global
 - static

echo and print

- **echo** and **print** are more or less the **same**. They are both used *to output data* to the screen.
- The differences are small: **echo** has *no return value* while **print** has a *return value of 1* so it can be used in expressions.
- **echo** can take multiple parameters (although such usage is rare) while **print** can take one argument.
- **echo** is marginally faster than **print**.

echo and print

```
<?php  
echo "<h2>PHP is Fun!</h2>";  
echo "Hello world!<br>";  
echo "I'm about to learn PHP!<br>";  
echo "This ", "string ", "was ", "made ", "with multiple parameters.";  
?>
```

References

- W3 Schools – [w3schools.com](https://www.w3schools.com)
- Web Programming with HTML5, CSS, and JavaScript – John Dean – Jones & Bartlett Publishers, 2019.